

Lesson 18: “Establish ... a House of God” (See L18 [Class Member Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand the significance of temples and inspire us to seek the blessings of the temple in our lives.

1. The Lord commanded the Saints to build the Kirtland Temple.

- D&C 95.

President Frederick G. Williams said the First Presidency knelt in prayer, and a model of the building “appeared within viewing distance.... After we had taken a good look at the exterior, the building seemed to come right over us.” When the temple was completed, Frederick G. Williams said it looked exactly as it had in the vision. (In *The Revelations of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, comp. Lyndon W. Cook [1981], 198)

2. The Saints were blessed for their great sacrifices in building the temple.

What were some of the challenges and sacrifices of building the Kirtland Temple?

See *Our Heritage*, pages 33-34. Scroll down to “[The Kirtland Temple](#)”.

How were the Saints blessed for the sacrifices they made in building the temple?

See *Our Heritage*, pages 34-35. Scroll down to “[Dedication of the Temple](#)”.

3. Joseph Smith dedicated the Kirtland Temple.

“On 27 March 1836, the Prophet Joseph Smith dedicated the Kirtland Temple. The dedicatory prayer, which the Lord revealed, is recorded in D&C 109. The dedicatory service lasted seven hours and was accompanied by a great outpouring of the Spirit. It included the dedicatory prayer, hymn singing, testimony bearing, the passing of the sacrament, sermons, and a solemn assembly in which members sustained Joseph Smith and other Church leaders. The service ended with the Saints giving the Hosanna Shout—raising their hands above their heads and shouting three times, “Hosanna, hosanna, hosanna to God and the Lamb, amen, amen, and amen.” (*History of the Church*, 2:427-28; in the Lesson Manual)

†1. Orson Pratt †2. Terryl Givens

How are temples are different after they are dedicated? Your thoughts?

Spiritual Manifestations. See *Our Heritage*, 34-35. Scroll down to “[Dedication of the Temple](#)”.

- D&C 109: 7, 14; 17-19; 20-21; 23. What responsibilities were noted in the dedicatory prayer?

What blessings did the Prophet pray for?

- D&C 109: 15; 22; 25-26; 36-37; 44; 54-58; 61-64, 67; 72-74

4. The Lord accepted the Kirtland Temple, and ancient prophets restored priesthood keys.

- D&C 110.

5. Temple building and temple work accelerate in our day.

President Howard W. Hunter: “Let us be a temple-attending and a temple-loving people. Let us hasten to the temple as frequently as time and means and personal circumstances allow. Let us go not only for our kindred dead, but let us also go for the personal blessing of temple worship, for the sanctity and safety which is provided within those hallowed and consecrated walls. The temple is a place of beauty, it is a place of revelation, it is a place of peace. It is the house of the Lord. It is holy unto the Lord. It should be holy unto us.” (“[Exceeding Great and Precious Promises](#),” *Ensign*, Oct. 1994, 5)

†4. President Howard W. Hunter
†7. Elder Richard G. Scott

†5. Elder D. Todd Christofferson
†8. Elder David A. Bednar

†6. Elder Richard G. Scott

Next Week: Lesson 19: “The Plan of Salvation”; See L19 [Class Member Study Guide](#). † •

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).)

†1. **Orson Pratt on the period preceding the dedication of the Kirtland Temple:** “God was there, his angels were there, the Holy Ghost was in the midst of the people, the visions of the Almighty were opened to the minds of the servants of the living God; the veil was taken from the minds of many; they saw the heavens opened; they beheld the angels of God; they heard the voice of the Lord; and they were filled from the crown of their heads to the soles of their feet with the power and inspiration of the Holy Ghost.... In that Temple, set apart by the servants of God, and dedicated by a prayer that was written by inspiration, the people were blessed as they never had been blessed for generations.” (*Journal of Discourses*, 18:131-132)

†2. **Terryl Givens:** “On 21 January of that year, Joseph Smith met in the temple with his counselors and a few dozen leaders. At that time, the prophet’s scribe recorded, “the heavens were opened upon us.” Joseph saw “the celestial kingdom of God, and ... the transcendent beauty of the gate through which the heirs of that kingdom will enter, which was like unto circling flames of fire.” ... [23-24]

“Of the other brethren present, some saw what Joseph saw and others beheld ‘the armies of Heaven protecting the Saints.... Some saw the face of the Savior, and others were ministered unto by holy angels, and the spirit of prophecy and revelation was poured out in mighty power.’ Over the next three and a half months, as reported in countless diaries and letters, individuals and groups as large as a thousand in number reported visions, the voices and visitation of angels, the gift of tongues, and other miraculous manifestations. Even the Mormon children of Kirtland reported throngs of heavenly beings gathered above the temple. (*The Latter-day Saint Experience in America*, 23-24)

†3. **President Howard W. Hunter:** “Keep a picture of a temple in your home that your children may see it. Teach them about the purposes of the house of the Lord. Have them plan from their earliest years to go there and to remain worthy of that blessing.” (“[Exceeding Great and Precious Promises](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1994, 8)

†4. **Elder D. Todd Christofferson** told of the 2007 earthquake in Peru. Elder Marcus B. Nash met Branch President Wenceslao Conde and his wife Pamela. “He asked about the Conde’s home.

“‘It’s gone,” she said simply.

“‘What about your belongings?” he inquired.

“‘Everything was buried in the rubble of our home,” Sister Conde replied.

“‘And yet,” Elder Nash noted, “you are smiling as we talk.”

“‘Yes,” she said, “I have prayed and I am at peace. We have all we need. We have each other, we have our children, we are sealed in the temple, we have this marvelous Church, and we have the Lord. We can build again with the Lord’s help.”

...

“What is the source of such moral and spiritual power, and how do we obtain it? The source is God. Our access to that power is through our covenants with Him.” (“[The Power of Covenants](#),” *Ensign*, May 2009, 19-23)

†5. **Elder Richard G. Scott:** “Fourteen years ago I decided to attend the temple and complete an ordinance at least once a week. When I am traveling I make up the missed visits... I have kept that resolve, and it has changed my life profoundly.” (“[Temple Worship: The Source of Strength and Power in Times of Need](#),” *Ensign*, May 2009, 43-45)

†6. **Elder Richard G. Scott** quoted Sarah DeArmon Pea Rich, an ancestor of his wife, Jeanene.

“Many were the blessings we had received in the house of the Lord, which has caused us joy and comfort in the midst of all our sorrows and enabled us to have faith in God, knowing He would guide us and sustain us in the unknown journey that lay before us. For if it had not been for the faith and knowledge that was bestowed upon us in that temple by the influence and help of the Spirit of the Lord, our journey would have been like one taking a leap in the dark. To start out on such a journey in the winter as it were and in our state of poverty, it would seem like walking into the jaws of death. But we had faith in our Heavenly Father, and we put our trust in Him feeling that we were His chosen people and had embraced His gospel, and instead of sorrow, we felt to rejoice that the day of our deliverance had come.”² (“[Temple Worship: The Source of Strength and Power in Times of Need](#),” *Ensign*, May 2009, 43-45)

†7. **Elder David A. Bednar** told about temple-attending members. ““And they shall be gathered into the garners, that they are not wasted’ (Alma 26:5).

“The sheaves in this analogy represent newly baptized members of the Church. The garners are the holy temples...

““Yea, they shall not be beaten down by the storm at the last day; yea, neither shall they be harrowed up by the whirlwinds; but when the storm cometh they shall be gathered together in their place, that the storm cannot penetrate to them; yea, neither shall they be driven with fierce winds whithersoever the enemy listeth to carry them” (Alma 26:6). (“[Honorably Hold a Name and Standing](#),” *Ensign*, May 2009, 97-100)

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